

Sham Satish Thakare

Independent Computer Science Researcher

Data Engineer / Machine Learning Specialist at Spectra Corporate Service

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Education

APCOER Pune — Pune, India

B.Tech. in Artificial Intelligence & Data Science | Jan 2020 – Jun 2024

- Cumulative GPA: **8.70 / 10.00**
 - Core Focus: Machine Learning, Probability & Statistics, Data Structures & Algorithms, Distributed Systems.
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Research / Professional Experience

Spectra Corporate Service — Pune, India

Data Engineer / Machine Learning Specialist | Jun 2024 – Present

- Engineered high-throughput parallel data processing systems and ML data pipelines using C++, Python, and SQL, optimizing memory layout and execution locality.
- Designed multithreaded cloud workflow automation and telemetry data processing pipelines enforcing concurrency invariants and data integrity.
- Implemented infrastructure performance benchmarking and automated execution suites across compute clusters to measure scale throughput.

APCOER Pune — Pune, India

Research Intern | Jun 2023 – Dec 2024

- Conducted independent research on machine learning algorithms and statistical data evaluation methods.
 - Provided instructional and teaching support for undergraduate coursework in *Data Structures, Algorithms, and Foundations of Machine Learning*.
 - Developed open-source benchmark scripts and automated test suites for algorithmic problem solving.
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Manuscripts & Publications

Submitted / Under Review

When Confidence Proxies Confound Reasoning Complexity: Pitfalls of Uncertainty-Weighted Credit Assignment in Language Model Reinforcement Learning

Sham Satish Thakare

Submitted to IEEE Transactions on Artificial Intelligence (IEEE TAI), 2026.

Falsifies token-predictive entropy as an uncertainty proxy in LM RLVR. Demonstrates predictive entropy correlates strongly with sequence length ($\rho = +0.486$), causing uncertainty-weighted GRPO to misallocate credit on valid multi-step derivations.

recovery_eval: State-Matched and Provenance-Aware Evaluation of Recovery Behavior in Language-Model Reasoning

Sham Satish Thakare

Submitted to 11th IEEE Special Session on Machine Learning on Big Data (IEEE BigData 2026 / MLBD, Submission ID: BigD497), 2026.

Formulates state-contrast continuation evaluation ($\rho_{\text{recovery}} = -0.1100$) measuring error recovery under frozen structural covariates across reasoning model rollouts.

StateShift: State-Matched Evaluation of Error Recovery in Neural Reasoning

Sham Satish Thakare

Submitted to Elsevier Artificial Intelligence (AIJ, Manuscript ID: ARTINT-D-26-01491), 2026.

Evaluates neural reasoning continuation state matching under verifier perturbations and structural covariate controls.

Working Papers

Amortized Intervention Frontiers for Language-Model Reasoning: When Does Training Beat Search?

Sham Satish Thakare | Working Paper, 2026 (Target under consideration: TMLR)

Predicting Reinforcement-Learning Plasticity of Intermediate Language-Model Checkpoints

Sham Satish Thakare | Working Paper, 2026 (Target under consideration: JMLR)

EnclaveShield: Zero-Knowledge Memory Attestation and Side-Channel Mitigation for Hardware Enclaves

Sham Satish Thakare | Working Paper, 2026 (Target under consideration: IEEE TDSC)

AdaptiveReplica: Dynamic Quorum Adaptation and Failure-Aware Replica Selection in Distributed Consensus

Sham Satish Thakare | Working Paper, 2026 (Target under consideration: IEEE TPDS)

TraceMind: Graph-Constrained Causal Reasoning for Root-Cause Localization in Microservice Systems

Sham Satish Thakare | Working Paper, 2026 (Target under consideration: IEEE TCC)

Research Software & Artifacts

- **ear_grpo_reasoning**: LM RL credit assignment probing suite exposing length confounding in token predictive entropy. (https://github.com/shamddd/ear_grpo_reasoning)
- **recovery_eval**: State-matched continuation evaluation protocol measuring error recovery under frozen structural covariates. (https://github.com/shamddd/recovery_eval)

- **quorumshift**: Failure-domain aware dynamic quorum adaptation in C++20 Raft consensus clusters.
(<https://github.com/shamddd/quorumshift>)
 - **enclaveshield**: Zero-knowledge memory attestation proofs and adaptive Path ORAM tree rebalancing.
(<https://github.com/shamddd/enclaveshield>)
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Selected Technical Skills

- **Research & ML**: Reinforcement Learning (GRPO/PPO), Foundation Model Evaluation, PyTorch, Model Probing, Statistical Hypothesis Testing.
- **Systems Research**: Distributed Consensus (Raft), Confidential Computing (Path ORAM/ZK Attestation), C++20 Multithreading, Concurrency Controls.
- **Professional Engineering**: High-Throughput Data Pipelines, Linux Systems Administration, SQL Optimization, Docker, Cloud Telemetry.
- **Programming Languages**: C++, Python, SQL, Bash.